

The beta version of the upcoming RHEL includes smart card authentication with Active Directory. Additionally, there are SELinux tools to speed up policy creation and offer ease of use. The platform also includes support for the OpenSCAP workbench and Media Access Control security (MACSec) version 2 for a secure user experience.

There are several reliability and redundancy features to give clients reason to switch to RHEL 7.3. In particular, the beta platform has complete support for high availability add-ons on IBM z systems. Customers can also dynamically configure RAID devices via RAID Takeover.

Apart from the IoT world, RHEL 7.3 beta is planning to 'streamline the life cycle' of containerised and cloud-native applications. There is an option to sign and verify container signatures using the technology preview of the Atomic CLI. Also, the platform has both the identity management (IdM) client and server services as container images through the Red Hat Container Registry, which enables the deployment of containers.

The latest beta version of RHEL comes with some performance enhancements as well. There are lightweight tunnels and an enhanced bulk packet memory allocator. Red Hat has included its support for non-volatile, dual in-line memory modules (NVDIMMs) to let the platform leverage high-performance storage.

Customers with an active RHEL subscription can test the features of the beta version. However, its final version would take some time to reach servers worldwide.

PHD Chamber and NeGD host national e-governance conference

PHD Chamber, in collaboration with NeGD (National E-Governance Division), recently hosted a national conference on e-governance in New Delhi. Called 'E-Governance: Deliveries on Transparency, Compliance and Good Governance,'



the conference discussed the roadmap for effective and robust e-governance implementation, the upgradation of the present e-governance model in India and other issues related to e-governance with a focus on health.

Held at the PHD House in New Delhi, the conference was

inaugurated by Prof. Suptendra Nath Sarbadhikari, project director of the National Institute of Health and Family Welfare (NIHFW), and Milan Narendra, partner at Ernst & Young India.

Sanjeev Shriya, chairman of the committee on electronics and ICT, PHD Chamber, in his welcome address said that the rise of e-governance had been one of the most striking developments of the Web. The increase in broadband and mobile connections shows that citizens today are expecting more and more information and services online, from governments and corporate organisations and thereby, strengthening the new 'e-citizenship' model, he added.

Shriya stated that e-governance offered benefits such as speed, cost reduction, transparency, accountability and convenience as well as providing citizens with increased access to information.

Atul Anand, co-chairman of the committee on electronics and ICT, PHD

Microsoft bug bounty now includes open source .NET Core and ASP.NET Core

Microsoft has expanded its existing bug bounty programme to cover open source .NET Core and ASP.NET Core. The software giant is set to pay monetary rewards to developers who dig into the RTM, beta and RC releases of the community-backed platforms.

To reach out to a large number of developers, Microsoft is giving away bounty payouts from US\$ 500 to US\$ 15,000. This will be based on the quality of the report. In addition to .NET Core and ASP.NET Core, payouts will also be made to those spotting bugs in Web server Kestrel. Developers can also find vulnerabilities in the default ASP.NET Core templates provided with the ASP.NET Web Tools Extension for Visual Studio 2015 or later.

"The vulnerability must be submitted on and reproduced on the latest RTM version or on supported beta or RC releases above the current RTM version to qualify for a bounty," Microsoft's security team said in a blog post.



Microsoft is running bug bounty programmes for products like Office 365, Azure and Edge. It is also rewarding developers finding exploitation within the Windows operating system.

In July, Microsoft released .NET Core 1.0 as its cross-platform open source offering for developers. The runtime platform was also developed for RHEL and OpenShift to offer .NET framework on a variety of environments.